/i18n

UI language: /i18n on|off|status|list| | /i18n help

Overview

`/i18n` controls UI internationalisation. When enabled, user-facing strings (the status bar, the `/help` header and the catalogue footer) are rendered from a locale message catalog; any key missing from the catalog falls back to the compiled English text.

Catalogs are JSON files named after the locale:

- `<project>/.ragent/locales/<locale>.json` (project, probed first)
- `~/.config/ragent/locales/<locale>.json` (user)

A locale tag such as `fr_FR.UTF-8` is probed as `fr_fr` and then `fr`.

The state persists in the `i18n` section of `ragent.json` (`i18n.enabled`, `i18n.locale`, default `false` / `en`). With no `i18n` section, a non-English ambient `LANG` that has an installed catalog enables translation automatically.

Syntax

```
/i18n              Show the effective state (same as /i18n status)
/i18n on           Enable translated strings and persist it
/i18n off          Disable translation and persist it
/i18n <locale>     Enable translation with the given locale and persist both
/i18n status       Show state, locale, and catalog availability
/i18n list         List installed locale catalogs
/i18n help         Print the help table
```

`--help` and `-h` are accepted as aliases of `help`. Subcommands are matched case-insensitively; any other token is treated as a locale tag.

Options / Subcommands

Form	Description
`on`	Apply `enabled = true` in-process, persist `i18n.enabled: true` via `ragent_config::i18n::persist`, then invalidate the session processor's config cache. The locale is unchanged.
`off`	Same as `on` with `enabled = false`; the compiled English text is served.
`<locale>`	Enable translation and persist both `i18n.enabled: true` and `i18n.locale: <locale>` (e.g. `/i18n fr`, `/i18n de_DE.UTF-8`).
`status`	Report the effective on/off state, effective locale, whether a catalog is loaded, whether one exists for the locale, and the persisted config value. Bare `/i18n` does the same.
`list`	Enumerate the `*.json` catalogs in both locale directories with their paths, or `(none installed; English is always available)`.
`help`	Print the help table. Note: the help text says bare `/i18n` shows help, but the dispatcher routes bare `/i18n` to `status`.

If persisting fails (config file not writable), the change still applies for the live session and the status line shows `i18n: unsaved`.

Examples

`/i18n fr`

Enables translation with the French catalog and writes `"i18n": { "enabled": true, "locale": "fr" }` to the active config source.

`/i18n off`

Returns to English and persists `i18n.enabled: false`.

`/i18n list`

Shows which locale catalogs are installed.

Output

`on`/`off`/`<locale>` confirm the change:

```
  UI internationalisation enabled (locale `fr`).
Catalog loaded: true
```

A failed persist surfaces as a warning:

```
  UI internationalisation enabled for this session, but saving the config failed: <e> (unsaved).
```

`status` prints `UI internationalisation`, `Effective locale`, `Catalog loaded`, `Catalog available` and `Persisted config` lines. If no catalog is found for an enabled non-English locale, a warning is logged and English is used.

Related

- config - general configuration commands; `i18n` is a `ragent.json` section.

Maintained alongside `crates/ragent-tui/src/app/slash.rs` (`handle_i18n_command`) and `crates/ragent-config/src/i18n.rs`; update when those change.